

IN 1900, EUROPEANS CONTROLLED 90 PERCENT OF AFRICA



Scramble for Africa

The Atlantic slave trade, in which Africans were forcibly sold to people in the Americas, ended in the mid-19th century. European powers colonized Africa for economic, political, and religious reasons, scrambling to claim territory before their rivals.

- **1871:** Germany and Italy are both unified. No more territory available for expansion of empires in Europe.
- **1884–85:** Berlin Conference, where European powers decide rules on carving up Africa.
- **1900:** Only a handful of regions are still independent states. Britain rules 30 percent of Africa's population.

The Great Game

In the 1830s, Britain feared Russia was planning on invading British-ruled India through controlling India's neighbor, Afghanistan. The "Great Game" was the rivalry for power in Asia between the British and Russian empires.

- **1839–42:** First Anglo-Afghan War. Terrible defeat at Kabul for the British.
- **1878–80:** Second Anglo-Afghan War. Russia is defeated and Britain withdraws but takes control of Afghanistan's foreign affairs.
- **1907:** Russia and Britain sign a peace treaty in the face of the German threat of expansion in the Middle East.